

Sunday 4 October 2026

Simon flies over; Jenifer is in the air

Cork → London

Tonight: **Premier Inn London Southwark (Borough High St)** · 135 Borough High Street, SE1 1NP
Booked from tonight, so the room is ready when Jenifer lands.

16:10 EI722 Cork → Heathrow 18:35 Manila QR 933 departs

THE DAY

16:10

☐ **Aer Lingus EI722, Cork → London Heathrow**
Lands 17:35. Seat 7D, one 20 kg checked bag. The confirmation doesn't give the Heathrow terminal, so check it on the day.

~17:45

TRAVEL

Heathrow → hotel, about 1 hr 15 min

Elizabeth line eastbound (toward Abbey Wood/Shenfield) to Farringdon, about 45 min. Change to Thameslink southbound, 3 stops to London Bridge. Borough High Street exit; the hotel is 4 min south on the left, at no. 135. Contactless, about £14.

~19:15

Check in

Evening

OPTIONAL

Millennium Bridge, 20 min, only if you have the energy

Five minutes to the river and over the bridge for St Paul's lit up, then home. Something quick to eat: Flat Iron Square, The Anchor Bankside or Padella, all within 5 min.

Bed

☐ **Alarm for about 05:00**
QR 011 lands at Heathrow T4 at 06:25.

Meanwhile **Jenifer: QR 933 Manila T3 18:35 → Doha 22:50**
Then QR 011 Doha 01:10 → Heathrow T4 06:25 Monday. Seats 22G / 52G.

BOOKINGS: FIND THE EMAIL

Aer Lingus EI722 (Simon)
Sun 4 Oct, 16:10 ORK → 17:35 LHR
Email: "Aer Lingus Confirmation - Booking Ref: ..."
from Aer Lingus, received 6 Sep, 11:40

Premier Inn Southwark, 8 nights
4 → 12 Oct
Email: "Your booking is confirmed. Ref no. ..."
from Premier Inn, received 19 Aug, 09:52

Qatar Airways QR 933 / QR 011 (Jenifer)
Sun 4 Oct 18:35 MNL → Mon 5 Oct 06:25 LHR T4
Email: "Booking confirmation : ..."
from Qatar Airways, received 16 Aug, 18:09

NOTES

- Heathrow border pack for Monday morning: printed separately (see the borders page).

Monday 5 October 2026

Arrival, then a slow first day

London

Tonight: **Premier Inn London Southwark (Borough High St)** · 135 Borough High Street, SE1 1NP

- 06:25 QR 011 lands T4
- ~17:00 London Eye (decide 15:30)
- 18:00 The George Inn

THE DAY

06:25	☐ QR 011 lands at Heathrow Terminal 4 Simon meets Jenifer at arrivals.
~07:00	TRAVEL Heathrow T4 → hotel, about 1 hr Elizabeth line eastbound to Farringdon, then Thameslink 3 stops to London Bridge, 4 min walk. Contactless, about £14 each.
~08:00	In the room. Shower, breakfast, sleep Nothing is planned before noon.
~13:00	EAT Light lunch around Borough Market (4 min) The stalls are shut on Mondays; Monmouth Coffee (2 Park St) and Bread Ahead (Cathedral St) are open.
Afternoon	Four free things within 5 min of the door Southwark Cathedral (20 min) · Winchester Palace ruin and the Golden Hinde, Clink St (15 min) · Crossbones Graveyard, Redcross Way (10 min).
15:30	☐ Decide on the London Eye If she's up for it, buy the last rotation online (londoneye.com, about £30pp; skip Fast Track). Nothing later than 17:00, because the George table is at 18:00.
16:30	TRAVEL Walk west along the South Bank, 25 min Past Tate Modern and the Millennium Bridge, under Blackfriars and Waterloo Bridges.
~17:00	OPTIONAL London Eye, last rotation, 30 min County Hall, SE1 7PB. If she's flat, skip it and walk the South Bank to Blackfriars instead.
17:35	TRAVEL Back east, 25 min walk Or the Jubilee line, Waterloo → London Bridge (2 stops).
18:00	EAT Dinner: The George Inn, booked 75 Borough High St, 2 min from the hotel. 2-hour table, back by 20:00 when busy. Bed by 21:00.

BOOKINGS: FIND THE EMAIL

The George Inn

Mon 5 Oct, 18:00, 2 people, 2 hrs

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Email: "Your Confirmed Booking at George (Southwark)"

from Greene King, received 29 Aug, 20:39

NOTES

- The Old Operating Theatre is shut Mon–Wed; it's on Thursday.

Tuesday 6 October 2026

The City and the Tower, all on foot

London

Tonight: **Premier Inn London Southwark (Borough High St)** · 135 Borough High Street, SE1 1NP

- 14:00 Tower of London
- 17:30 Garden at 120
- 19:30 El Pastór

THE DAY

Morning	Lie-in, then Borough Market at full strength 8 Southwark St, 4 min walk. Open Tue–Fri 10:00–17:00. Graze; lunch is at Leadenhall.
~11:30	TRAVEL <i>Over London Bridge into the City, 15 min walk</i> No tube all day.
Late AM	Leadenhall Market and St Dunstan in the East Both free. Leadenhall was Diagon Alley in the first film; St Dunstan is a Blitz ruin taken over by a garden.
~12:45	EAT Proper sit-down lunch under the Leadenhall roof Don't skip it.
14:00	☐ Tower of London Tower Hill, EC3N 4AB. All-day ticket, so 14:00 is the plan rather than a deadline. Last admission 16:30. Join a Yeoman Warder tour on arrival (every 30 min, free), then the Crown Jewels, White Tower and ravens. About 2.5 hrs.
~16:30	Walk across Tower Bridge Free. The Exhibition with the glass floor is optional: £18 each, last entry 17:00. Check bascule lift times at towerbridge.org.uk.
17:30	Garden at 120, 120 Fenchurch St Free, no booking. Rooftop on the 15th floor. Shuts 18:30; sunset 18:35. Bring a coat.
18:30	TRAVEL <i>Thames Path home in the dark, about 25 min</i> Back about 19:00.
19:30	EAT Dinner: El Pastór, booked 7A Stoney Street, SE1 9AA, 6 min from the hotel. 19:30–21:00. Table held 15 min. Cancelling inside 12 hrs costs £20pp.

BOOKINGS: FIND THE EMAIL

Tower of London, 2 adults Tue 6 Oct, all-day admission Email: "Expian Ticket Summary - ..." from Historic Royal Palaces, received 29 Aug, 16:03	El Pastór, Borough Market Tue 6 Oct, 19:30–21:00, 2 guests Email: "Your Reservation at El Pastor London Bridge Simon O'Donovan on 06/10/2026" from SevenRooms, received 14 Sep, 22:17
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NOTES

- Early night: tomorrow is St Paul's at 10:00 and Leavesden until 20:30.

Simon & Jenifer · UK, 4–17 October 2026 · Filled boxes are fixed times. Emails are in Simon's Gmail; times are when they arrived (Irish time).

Wednesday 7 October 2026

St Paul's, then the Studio Tour

London

Tonight: **Premier Inn London Southwark (Borough High St)** · 135 Borough High Street, SE1 1NP

- 10:00 St Paul's
- 13:00 Marquis Cornwallis
- 15:00 Train, Euston
- 16:30 Studio Tour

THE DAY

- 09:50

TRAVEL

Hotel → St Paul's, 10 min walk

Over the Millennium Bridge.
- 10:00

☐

St Paul's Cathedral, dome climb

Enter by the West Entrance or the North Transept (step-free). 257 steps to the Whispering Gallery, 528 to the Golden Gallery. Crypt: Nelson, Wellington, Wren. About 2 hrs. The dome is optional if the morning runs long; the afternoon is 4 hrs on your feet.
- ~12:00

Postman's Park, King Edward St, 2 min north

15 min. Tiles for everyday heroes.
- 12:25

TRAVEL

Leave the park: 30 min walk to Marchmont Street

Holborn Viaduct → Theobald's Rd → Guilford St → Russell Square. Short on time? Central line to Holborn, then Piccadilly to Russell Square, about 20 min.
- 13:00

EAT

Long lunch: The Marquis Cornwallis, booked 13:00–14:30

31 Marchmont St, WC1N 1AP. Held 15 min; 90 minutes only, so order promptly. This is the main meal of the day.
- 14:30

TRAVEL

Walk to Euston, 12 min

North to Tavistock Place, then west to the station.
- By 15:00

☐

Train Euston → Watford Junction, about 20 min

West Coast line, contactless, about £12pp return. Then the Mullany's shuttle bus to the studios, 15 min, every 20 min. Aim to arrive about 16:00.
- 16:30

☐

Warner Bros. Studio Tour, Dark Arts

Studio Tour Drive, Leavesden, WD25 7LR. No entry before 16:10. Self-paced, about 4 hrs; you reach the Backlot about 19:00, after dark. Butterbeer at the Backlot Café.
- ~20:30

TRAVEL

Shuttle → Watford Junction → Euston → hotel

Back about 21:45.
- Late

OPTIONAL

Something small, if anything

Bermondsey Street has the latest kitchens, or a nightcap at The Anchor Bankside.

BOOKINGS: FIND THE EMAIL

- St Paul's Cathedral, 2 adults

Wed 7 Oct, 10:00 entry

Email: "St Paul's Cathedral Sightseeing Tickets"

from St Paul's Cathedral, received 29 Aug, 16:31

The Marquis Cornwallis

Wed 7 Oct, 13:00–14:30, 2 people

Email: "The Marquis Cornwallis | Booking Confirmation (DMN-...)"

from Collins Bookings, received 27 Aug, 21:28
- WB Studio Tour, 2 adults

Wed 7 Oct, 16:30 entry

Email: "Booking Confirmation and Tickets - Order number: ..."

from WB Studio Tour, received 24 Aug, 21:00

Thursday 8 October 2026

Natural History Museum, then Totoro

London

Tonight: **Premier Inn London Southwark (Borough High St)** · 135 Borough High Street, SE1 1NP

- 10:30 Natural History Museum
- 17:00 Caravan
- 19:00 Totoro

THE DAY

- 09:30

OPTIONAL

If you're up early: St James's Park and Green Park

Only if you're out by 09:30. From St James's Park station it's 4 stops on the District line to South Kensington.
- 10:00

TRAVEL

Hotel → South Kensington, about 30 min

Jubilee line London Bridge → Green Park, then the Piccadilly line to South Kensington. Use the museum subway from the station.
- 10:30

☐

Natural History Museum

Cromwell Road, SW7 5BD. Hintze Hall (blue whale) first, then the dinosaurs, then Earth Hall. Small bite inside about 12:15.
- 13:50

TRAVEL

Leave. Piccadilly → Green Park → Jubilee → London Bridge

In the room by about 14:25.
- 14:45

OPTIONAL

The Old Operating Theatre, 6 min from the hotel

9a St Thomas St, SE1 9RY. About £7.50pp, open Thu–Sun 10:30–17:00. 45 min, then back to change.
- 16:25

TRAVEL

Hotel → Drury Lane, about 30 min

Northern line London Bridge → Bank, then Central line to Holborn, 5 min walk.
- 17:00

EAT

Dinner: Caravan Covent Garden, booked 17:00–18:30

30–35 Drury Lane, next door to the theatre. Ask for the pre-theatre menu (£25 for 2 courses, £29 for 3). Card only.
- 19:00

☐

My Neighbour Totoro, Gillian Lynne Theatre

166 Drury Lane, WC2B 5PW. Stalls I41 and I42. About 2.5 hrs with interval.
- ~21:40

TRAVEL

Home, about 40 min

Holborn → Central → Bank → Northern → London Bridge. Back about 22:20.

BOOKINGS: FIND THE EMAIL

- Natural History Museum, 2 adults (free slot)

Thu 8 Oct, 10:30

Email: "Natural History Museum Order #..."

from Natural History Museum, received 29 Aug, 19:08
- Caravan Covent Garden

Thu 8 Oct, 17:00–18:30, 2 guests

Email: "Your Reservation at Caravan Covent Garden | Simon O'Donovan on 08/10/2026"

from SevenRooms, received 29 Aug, 19:03
- My Neighbour Totoro

Thu 8 Oct, 19:00, stalls I41 & I42

Email: "Thank You For Booking With LW Tickets"

from LW Tickets, received 25 Aug, 19:47

NOTES

- Kew for Saturday isn't booked yet. Check the forecast today and book at [kew.org](https://www.kew.org) if it looks dry.

Simon & Jenifer · UK, 4–17 October 2026 · Filled boxes are fixed times. Emails are in Simon's Gmail; times are when they arrived (Irish time).

Friday 9 October 2026

Covent Garden, Seven Dials and Soho, then the dinner of the week

London

Tonight: **Premier Inn London Southwark (Borough High St)** · 135 Borough High Street, SE1 1NP

- 14:30 Hunterian
- 18:15 Leave hotel
- 19:00 Le Café du Marché

THE DAY

- 09:30

TRAVEL

Hotel → Holborn, about 30 min

Northern line to Bank, then Central line to Holborn. Nothing before 14:30 is booked, so a lie-in is fine.
- 10:00

Neal's Yard and Seven Dials

Go early; the yard is tiny. Neal's Yard Remedies on the corner.
- 10:40

Cecil Court, off Charing Cross Road

Victorian alley of old booksellers; Watkins Books.
- 11:15

EAT

Sweet stop 1: Maison Bertaux, 28 Greek St

Share one slice; the only sit-down stop. The rule today: one thing per stop, shared.
- 11:55

EAT

Stops 2–3: Venchi (James St), then Ladurée (Market Building)

Walk through the piazza; don't stop in it.
- 12:35

EAT

Stop 4: Bageriet, 24 Rose St

One cardamom bun, shared.
- 13:00

EAT

Seven Dials Market, 35 Earlham St: the savoury stop

HOKO wonton noodle soup → Cucumber Alley dumplings → Chin Chin ice cream. Last food until dinner.
- 14:30

☐

Hunterian Museum, free timed slot

Royal College of Surgeons, 38–43 Lincoln's Inn Fields, WC2A 3PE. No backpacks (lockers first come). About an hour.
- 15:35

TRAVEL

Holborn → hotel

Central → Bank → Northern → London Bridge. In by about 16:05; two hours to change.
- 18:15

TRAVEL

Hotel → Charterhouse Square, about 30 min

Thameslink London Bridge → Farringdon (2 stops). Then 8 min up St John Street, under St John's Gate, left into Charterhouse Square. The restaurant is down the cobbled mews in the far corner; look for the arch.
- 19:00

EAT

Dinner: Le Café du Marché, booked

22 Charterhouse Mews, EC1M 6DX. Piano from 19:30. Kitchen winds down about 21:30; 20 min grace.
- ~21:30

OPTIONAL

Nightcap: The Fox and Anchor, 115 Charterhouse St (quiet)

Or Be At One, 40–42 Charterhouse St (lively).
- Home

TRAVEL

Walk 35 min over the Millennium Bridge, or Thameslink Farringdon → London Bridge (6 min)

If you have the nightcap, take the train. Tomorrow you leave for Kew at 09:15.

BOOKINGS: FIND THE EMAIL

Hunterian Museum, 2 tickets (free) Fri 9 Oct, 14:30–15:00 slot Email: "Order Confirmation for Hunterian Museum - Free timed entry October 2026" from Eventbrite, received 29 Aug, 19:31	Le Café du Marché Fri 9 Oct, 19:00, table for 2 Email: "Your booking confirmation for Le Cafe du Marche" from OpenTable, received 27 Aug, 19:47
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NOTES

- Novelty Automation (1a Princeton St, near Holborn, open to 18:00, about £5 in tokens) only if the afternoon runs short; it comes out of the change time.

Saturday 10 October 2026

Kew, Petersham and Richmond Hill

London

Tonight: **Premier Inn London Southwark (Borough High St)** · 135 Borough High Street, SE1 1NP

- 10:00 Kew opens
- 14:00 Petersham Teahouse
- ~18:12 Sunset, Richmond Hill

THE DAY

- 09:15

TRAVEL *Hotel → Kew Gardens, about 1 hr*

Jubilee line London Bridge → Westminster, then the District line toward Richmond, to Kew Gardens. 5 min walk to Victoria Gate.
- 10:00

Kew Gardens, about 3 hrs, one loop

Palm House first (walkway at the top of the spiral stairs) → Waterlily House → Great Broad Walk Borders → Temperate House → Sackler Crossing → The Hive (lie on the glass floor) → Treetop Walkway.
- ~13:00

TRAVEL *District line 2 stops to Richmond, then the towpath to Petersham, 25 min*

Walk down to Richmond Bridge and follow the Thames towpath south. Bus 65 if it's wet.
- 14:00

EAT **Lunch: Petersham Nurseries Teahouse**

Church Ln, off Petersham Rd, TW10 7AB. Walk-in only, about £28pp. The Teahouse, not the Restaurant. Then the shop.
- ~15:30

Richmond Park, about 2 hrs

In at Petersham Gate → Pembroke Lodge → King Henry's Mound (St Paul's through the hedge) → Pen Ponds → out at Richmond Gate. It's the deer rut: keep 50 m away.
- ~17:30

Richmond Hill at sunset (about 18:12)

Terrace Gardens, TW10 6RN. The Roebuck is across the road; the Petersham Hotel if it's cold.
- Evening

EAT **Dinner in Richmond, 10 min down the hill**

Then District line home, about 45 min.

BOOKINGS: FIND THE EMAIL

Kew Gardens (not booked)
Sat 10 Oct, from 10:00
.....
No confirmation email yet.

NOTES

- Wet version: Kew until 14:00, lunch at Petersham, bus 65 into Richmond, then the Petersham Hotel lounge or home early.

Sunday 11 October 2026

The East End: flowers, thrifting and a rooftop sunset

London

Tonight: **Premier Inn London Southwark (Borough High St)** · 135 Borough High Street, SE1 1NP
Last night here. Pack tonight.

- 08:45 Columbia Road
- 17:30 Boundary Rooftop

THE DAY

~08:00	TRAVEL Hotel → Columbia Road
	Nearest stations: Hoxton (Overground) or Bethnal Green. Check the route on the morning; weekend engineering works are common.
08:45	Columbia Road Flower Market (Sundays only) Buy her flowers. Vintage Heaven (no. 82) and the Cake Hole tearoom; coffee on Ezra Street; Angela Flanders perfumer, no. 96.
~10:45	TRAVEL Walk south to Brick Lane, 10 min
11:00	Brick Lane and the Old Truman Brewery, about 3 hrs Vintage Market (basement), Blitz (55 Hanbury St), Absolute Vintage, Rokit / Beyond Retro / Atika (Cheshire St), Rough Trade East.
Anytime	EAT Dark Sugars (141 Brick Lane), Beigel Bake (159 Brick Lane) Hot chocolate under shaved chocolate; salt beef bagel about £5.
14:00	Hanbury Street murals and Fournier Street 1720s Huguenot silk-weavers' houses. 30 min.
15:00	EAT Old Spitalfields and Petticoat Lane (Middlesex St) Graze through the Spitalfields food stalls: Humble Crumble, Crosstown.
~17:15	TRAVEL Walk to Redchurch Street, about 12 min Up through Spitalfields, Brick Lane, left at the top.
17:30	EAT Boundary Rooftop, glass Orangery, booked 2–4 Boundary St, entrance on Redchurch St, E2 7DD. Sunset 18:10. Kitchen to 23:00, so dinner can be the same table. Held 15 min. 18+, cashless.
~19:30	TRAVEL Shoreditch High Street → London Bridge, about 20 min Pack tonight: checkout and the York train tomorrow.

BOOKINGS: FIND THE EMAIL

Boundary Rooftop, Indoor Dining
Sun 11 Oct, 17:30, 2 guests
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Email: **"Your Reservation at Boundary Rooftop | Simon O'Donovan on 11/10/2026"**
from SevenRooms, received 12 Sep, 17:23

NOTES

- Three years and eleven months today.

Monday 12 October 2026

North to York

London → York

Tonight: **Travelodge York Central Micklegate** · Micklegate, YO1 6JG
Twin room booked; ask at the desk for a double. Room only, no breakfast.

- 12:00 Check out
- 12:33 LNER to York
- 19:15 Rustique

THE DAY

11:45	☐ Check out of Premier Inn Southwark (deadline 12:00) Check the room twice.
11:50	TRAVEL <i>Borough → King's Cross St Pancras, about 20 min</i> Borough station, 2 min from the door. Northern line northbound, Bank branch, 6 stops, no change.
12:33	☐ LNER King's Cross → York, arrives 14:26 Coach B, seats 21 and 22. Advance singles: valid on this train only.
14:26	TRAVEL <i>York station → hotel, about 10 min walk</i> Straight up Micklegate. Check in from 15:00.
15:20	The Shambles and the snickelways Down Micklegate, over Ouse Bridge, up Parliament St, about 12 min. York Ghost Merchants at 6 Shambles if the queue is short (closes 17:30).
15:30	OPTIONAL Swap: The Cat's Whiskers, 46 Goodramgate Monday is the only slot (closed Tuesdays), about £8–10 each for an hour. It replaces the Ghost Merchants queue.
16:15	EAT Roberto gelato, 3 Goodramgate Shuts at 17:00.
16:45	Dean's Park, Minster Yard The quiet lawn against the Minster's north wall. 15 min.
17:05	Museum Gardens and St Mary's Abbey Gates close 18:00; head out of the bottom gate about 17:45.
17:45	TRAVEL <i>Along the Ouse back to Micklegate, 20 min</i>
19:15	EAT Dinner: Rustique, booked 19:15–21:00 28 Castlegate, 10 min from the hotel. French bistro.
21:15	OPTIONAL Nightcap: The Falcon Tap, 94 Micklegate 30 seconds from the door, closes 22:00.

BOOKINGS: FIND THE EMAIL

LNER King's Cross → York Mon 12 Oct, 12:33 → 14:26, Coach B 21 & 22 Email: "Your reservation from London Kings Cross to York is confirmed!" from LNER, received 6 Sep, 13:13	Travelodge York Central Micklegate, 2 nights 12 → 14 Oct Email: "Your Travelodge booking confirmation" from Travelodge, received 6 Sep, 20:21
Rustique Mon 12 Oct, 19:15–21:00, 2 people Email: "Rustique Restaurant Booking Confirmation (DMN-...)" from Collins Bookings, received 19 Sep, 15:53	

NOTES

- Monk Bar Chocolatiers is shut today; it's tomorrow.

Tuesday 13 October 2026

All of York, on foot

York

Tonight: **Travelodge York Central Micklegate** · Micklegate, YO1 6JG

- 14:30 Cocoa Works
- 17:45 Ambiente
- 20:00 Ghost Walk

THE DAY

- 09:30

EAT

Breakfast: Partisan, 112 Micklegate

2 min down the street. If the wait is over 15 min, try the Bar Convent café (17 Blossom St). For just coffee and a pastry, Spring Espresso (21 Lendal).
- 10:25

The browsing morning, about 2 hrs

Over Ouse Bridge → The Vintage Works, 8 Grape Lane (opens 10:30) → The Antiques Centre, 41 Stonegate → Stonegate → out through Bootham Bar → Gillygate: Blue Balloon, Rebound.
- OPTIONAL

York Minster, optional

About £20. The Great East Window and the Undercroft. Tower tickets are sold at the desk only.
- 12:50

City walls: Bootham Bar → Monk Bar

The stairs are inside Bootham Bar. About 15 min, looking down on the Minster's east front.
- 13:10

Goodramgate charity shops, down to the Shambles

RSPCA, Oxfam, BHF, Sue Ryder, Mind.
- EAT

Monk Bar Chocolatiers, 7 Shambles

The molten chocolate shot. Today is the only day it's open.
- 13:40

EAT

Lunch: Shambles Market street-food row

£6–10 a plate. Leave about 14:05.
- 14:05

TRAVEL

Down Coppergate to Castlegate, 10 min
- 14:30

☐

York Cocoa Works bar-making workshop, 14:30–15:45

10 Castlegate, YO1 9RN. Tell the guide about any allergy. The bar sets for about 30 min, so you'll leave around 16:15. 10% off in the shop.
- 16:15

EAT

Luxury Ice Cream Company, Swinegate

Then back to the hotel with your feet up.
- 17:30

TRAVEL

Hotel → Fossgate, 15 min
- 17:45

EAT

Dinner: Ambiente Tapas, booked 17:45–19:30

31 Fossgate, the Fossgate branch, not Goodramgate. Pay by about 19:45.
- 20:00

☐

The Original Ghost Walk of York

Meets outside The King's Arms, King's Staith (the bottom of Ouse Bridge). £10 each, cash. No booking. About 80 min; ends near the Minster about 21:20.
- 21:20

TRAVEL

Walk home: Stonegate → St Helen's Sq → Ouse Bridge → Micklegate, 20 min

Bring the hoods.

BOOKINGS: FIND THE EMAIL

York Cocoa Works, 2 adults Tue 13 Oct, 14:30–15:45 Email: "Confirmation: Chocolate Bar Making at York Cocoa Works on Tuesday, 13 October 2026 @ 2:30pm - 3:45pm" from FareHarbor, received 10 Sep, 22:31	Ambiente Tapas, Fossgate Tue 13 Oct, 17:45–19:30, 2 guests Email: "Your Reservation at Ambiente Fossgate Simon O'Donovan on 13/10/2026" from SevenRooms, received 12 Sep, 12:24
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NOTES

- Wet day: skip Gillygate and the wall; take the Merchant Adventurers' Hall (Fossgate, about £8), then JORVIK or the Castle Museum near Castlegate.
- Bring £20 in cash for the ghost walk.

Wednesday 14 October 2026

Bettys, the coast train, and Calton Hill

York → Edinburgh

Tonight: **Travelodge Edinburgh Central** · 33 St Mary's Street, EH1 1TA
Breakfast prepaid for both of you, both mornings.

- 12:19 LNER to Edinburgh
- 18:15 Calton Hill
- 19:30 Devil's Advocate

THE DAY

- 09:35

TRAVEL *Hotel → St Helen's Square, 10 min*
Leave the bags in the room.
- 09:45

EAT **Breakfast: Bettys, 6–8 St Helen's Square**
No bookings. If the queue has started, Little Bettys at 46 Stonegate (sit upstairs).
- 10:50

Stonegate on the way back
Last of the shopping.
- By 11:35

☐ **Check out of the Travelodge (deadline 12:00)**
Optional: Micklegate Bar stairs → the short stretch of wall toward Barker Tower, 10 min round trip.
- 11:45

TRAVEL *Down Micklegate to the station*
- 12:19

☐ **LNER York → Edinburgh Waverley, arrives 14:39**
Coach G, seats 13 and 14, right-hand side. Advance singles, this train only. Durham about 45 min in; the coast from Alnmouth; then Bamburgh and Berwick.
- 14:39

At Waverley: ask at left luggage about Friday
Opening time, price, and whether they take 20 kg cases.
- 14:50

TRAVEL *Waverley → hotel, 10 min uphill*
Market Street exit → Cockburn Street → turn right on the High Street → St Mary's Street is on the right at the Netherbow.
Taxi rank on Waverley Bridge, about £8.
- 15:10

Check in, drop everything
Check-in from 15:00.
- 15:40

OPTIONAL **Dean Village, 30 min walk**
Down the Mound → Princes St → Queensferry St → Bells Brae. Skip it if you leave after 15:45.
- 16:30

OPTIONAL **Water of Leith Walkway → Stockbridge, 25 min**
Cake at Books N' Cup, 16 Raeburn Place; then Circus Lane.
- 17:45

TRAVEL *Bus 24 or 29 → east end of Princes St, 10 min*
£2.40, tap contactless.
- 18:15

Calton Hill at sunset
Steps off Waterloo Place. Dugald Stewart Monument for the view. The best half hour is just after sunset. Wear your warmest coat.
- 19:30

EAT **Dinner: The Devil's Advocate, booked 19:30–21:30**
9 Advocate's Close, off the Royal Mile. Held 15 min. A cancellation or no-show inside 48 hrs is £10pp.

BOOKINGS: FIND THE EMAIL

- LNER York → Edinburgh**
Wed 14 Oct, 12:19 → 14:39, Coach G 13 & 14
Email: **"Your reservation from York to Edinburgh is confirmed!"**
from LNER, received 6 Sep, 18:04

Travelodge Edinburgh Central, 2 nights
14 → 16 Oct
Email: **"Your Travelodge booking confirmation"**
from Travelodge, received 6 Sep, 16:58
- The Devil's Advocate**
Wed 14 Oct, 19:30–21:30, 2 people
Email: **"The Devil's Advocate Bar & Kitchen | Booking Confirmation (DMN-...)"**
from Collins Bookings, received 12 Sep, 10:32

NOTES

- Generate a fresh UKVI share code today or tomorrow for the Cork folder. Write it down.

Thursday 15 October 2026

Arthur's Seat, the oldest pub in Scotland, and a secret garden

Edinburgh

Tonight: **Travelodge Edinburgh Central** · 33 St Mary's Street, EH1 1TA

- 10:30 Holyrood gate
- 13:30 Sheep Heid Inn
- 19:00 Angels with Bagpipes

THE DAY

- 09:00

EAT

Prepaid breakfast at the Travelodge, 09:00–09:45
The one lie-in of the fortnight.
- 10:15

TRAVEL

Down the Canongate to the Holyrood gate, 15 min
Fill water bottles and put coats on. There are no shops in the park.
- 10:30

Arthur's Seat, summit route
About 75 min up (rough steps at the top), 20 min on top, 40 min down the east side to Duddingston. Flat alternative: the low path round the south side, about 40 min. Pick at the gate.
- 12:45

Reach Duddingston
45 minutes in hand. On the flat route, do Dr Neil's Garden before lunch.
- 13:30

EAT

Lunch: The Sheep Heid Inn, booked
43–45 The Causeway, EH15 3QA. Restaurant area. Held 15 min only, so 13:45 is the deadline.
- ~14:45

Dr Neil's Garden, Old Church Lane
Free. Go via the Duddingston Kirk car park; the gate sticks, so shove it.
- 16:00

TRAVEL

Lothian bus 12 from Duddingston Road West, about 25 min
£2.40 contactless. (Not the 42.)
- 16:30

☐ **At the hotel: weigh her bag**
The Ryanair allowance is 20 kg. Stand on the bathroom scale with and without the bag. If it's over, buy extra weight online tonight.

If Waverley left luggage didn't suit, ask the Travelodge desk to hold the bags tomorrow until about 17:00
- 19:00

EAT

Dinner: Angels with Bagpipes, booked
343 High Street, 5 min from the hotel. Kitchen to 21:15.
- 20:45

OPTIONAL

One drink: Hoot the Redeemer, 7 Hanover St
Unmarked red door. Skip it without guilt.

BOOKINGS: FIND THE EMAIL

The Sheep Heid Inn Thu 15 Oct, 13:30, 2 people, Restaurant Email: "Your Booking is Confirmed at The Sheep Heid Inn on Thursday, 15th October 2026" from mycountrypub, received 10 Sep, 22:18	Angels with Bagpipes Thu 15 Oct, 19:00, 2 people Email: "Your booking confirmation for Angels with Bagpipes" from OpenTable, received 12 Sep, 15:03
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NOTES

- Rain: take the flat path round the base. The Palace of Holyroodhouse (about £20) is the indoor fallback.

Tonight: **Moxy Edinburgh Airport** · 1 Fairview Road, EH28 8AP
No shuttle. About 800 yds from the terminal. No breakfast included.

- 10:00 Castle
- 13:50 Mary King's Close check-in
- 17:25 Tram
- 19:00 Folder hour

THE DAY

08:45

☐ **Check out; bags to Waverley left luggage (or the Travelodge desk)**
No suitcases or rucksacks over 30 L are allowed at the Castle.

~09:40

TRAVEL *Up the Royal Mile to the Castle, 15 min*

10:00

☐ **Edinburgh Castle, entry 10:00–10:30**
St Margaret's Chapel, the Honours of Scotland, Mons Meg and the Great Hall, the National War Memorial (no photos), the north battlements. 2–2.5 hrs.

12:00

Victoria Street → Victoria Terrace → the Grassmarket
Go up onto the terrace for the photo.

12:30

EAT **Lunch in the Grassmarket, walk-in**
Petit Paris (38–40) or Maison Bleue, Biddy Mulligans, The Last Drop. The One O'Clock Gun fires at 13:00.

13:35

TRAVEL *Leave the Grassmarket, 10 min up to St Giles'*

13:50

☐ **Check in: The Real Mary King's Close, tour 14:00**
2 Warriston's Close, on the Royal Mile opposite St Giles'. About an hour, cold and enclosed. Out about 15:05.

15:30

☐ **OPTIONAL** **Maison de Moggy cat café, 17–19 West Port**
Walk-up, from £12 each, hourly slots. Shoes off. If it's full: the National Museum of Scotland (free, 7 min) or Armchair Books next door.

16:30

EAT **Mary's Milk Bar, 19 Grassmarket**
Hot chocolate float. Buy a box of chocolates for tonight.

16:55

TRAVEL *Grassmarket → Waverley (15 min), collect the bags → St Andrew Square (5 min)*

17:25

☐ **Tram to Ingliston Park & Ride, about 28 min**
Buy a City single (£2.40) before boarding. Get off one stop before the airport, then walk about 10 min / 0.4 mi to the Moxy. If it's pouring, ride to the airport instead (about £8).

~18:15

Check in at the Moxy
Free drink at check-in; Bar Moxy does food all night.

19:00

☐ **The folder hour: check the Cork folder, all of it in hand luggage**
BMU email on top · FR3732 itinerary + Manila–Heathrow booking · the Southwark, York and Edinburgh hotel confirmations · fresh UKVI share code + eVisa on the phone and as a PDF · the Irish SSVWP page · the January flight, Simon's letter, passport copy, funds, insurance.

☐ **Check both boarding passes in the Ryanair app and screenshot them onto both phones**
A restricted pass for Jenifer is normal: her document is checked at the bag drop. Don't pay the airport check-in fee.

21:00

Chocolates, the telly, phones on charge, both alarms at 04:15
Bags by the door.

BOOKINGS: FIND THE EMAIL

Edinburgh Castle, 2 adults
Fri 16 Oct, entry 10:00–10:30

Email: **"Historic Environment Scotland Order ..."**
from Historic Environment Scotland, received 19 Sep, 13:40

The Real Mary King's Close, 2 adults
Fri 16 Oct, 14:00 tour, check in 13:50

Email: **"Thank you for booking your tour at The Real Mary King's Close"**
from Real Mary King's Close, received 8 Sep, 21:49

Moxy Edinburgh Airport, 1 night
16 → 17 Oct, Queen Sleeper

Email: **"Reservation Confirmation #... for Moxy Edinburgh Airport"**
from Marriott, received 6 Sep, 18:42

Saturday 17 October 2026

FR3732 to Cork, and the Irish border

Edinburgh → Cork

Tonight: **Home: Blarney, Co. Cork** · About 25 min by car from Cork Airport

- 04:15 Alarm
- 06:25 Bag drop closes
- 07:05 FR3732
- 08:25 Land Cork

THE DAY

04:15	☐ Alarm Bags were packed last night and the folder is in hand luggage.
04:30	TRAVEL <i>Walk to the terminal, about 10 min</i> 800 yds, across one road.
04:45	☐ Ryanair bag drop (closes 06:25) Two 20 kg bags. Jenifer's document is checked here if her pass is restricted. Have the Irish SSVWP notice and the BMU email out.
05:15	Security Breakfast airside.
06:30	Gate Sunrise isn't until about 07:45. Sleep on the flight.
07:05	☐ FR3732 Edinburgh → Cork, 1 hr 20 min Seats 02B (Simon) and 02C (Jenifer).
08:25	☐ Land at Cork → immigration Simon goes to the desk with her. Entry under the Short Stay Visa Waiver Programme. Give the January departure date and put the onward ticket on the counter. A supervisor check is normal. Check the stamp is legible before you walk away.
~09:15	TRAVEL <i>Car to Blarney, about 25 min</i> Nothing to book.

BOOKINGS: FIND THE EMAIL

Ryanair FR3732, both travellers
Sat 17 Oct, 07:05 EDI → 08:25 ORK
.....
Email: **"Ryanair Travel Itinerary"**
from Ryanair, received 5 Sep, 14:39

NOTES

- If FR3732 is cancelled, fly Edinburgh → Dublin (several flights a day), then the train Heuston → Cork, about 2.5 hrs. The BMU accepts Dublin in writing. The entry deadline is 31 Oct.
- The full border brief is on the borders page.